

Core Skills

1. SQL
2. Excel
3. Power BI/Tableau
4. Basic Python
5. Communication
6. Business thinking

REALITY OF ENTRY-LEVEL INTERVIEWS

Most companies ask:

Round 1 — Resume + Aptitude

- SQL basics
- Excel
- logical reasoning
- communication

Round 2 — Technical

Mostly:

- joins
- group by
- business case questions
- dashboards
- basic Python/pandas

Round 3 — HR + Business Thinking

Questions like:

- “How would you analyze a sales drop?”
 - “How would you improve retention?”
 - “Tell me about your project.”
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MOST IMPORTANT THING

Companies hire freshers who can:

“Work with messy business data and explain insights clearly.”

Not people who memorize theory.

YOUR 90-DAY ROADMAP

PHASE 1 (Day 1–30)

Build a Strong Foundation

1. SQL (MOST IMPORTANT)

Spend:

2–3 hours daily

Master:

- SELECT
 - WHERE
 - GROUP BY
 - HAVING
 - JOINS
 - Subqueries
 - CASE WHEN
 - CTEs
 - Window Functions
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Practice Goal

Solve:

- 120–150 SQL questions

Daily:

- 10 questions minimum

Platforms:

- [LeetCode SQL](#)
 - [DataLemur](#)
 - [HackerRank SQL](#)
 - [StrataScratch](#)
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2. Excel

Learn:

- VLOOKUP/XLOOKUP
- Pivot tables
- Conditional formatting
- IF statements
- Charts
- Data cleaning

Practice:

- 1 hour daily

Best resource:

- ExcellsFun YouTube Channel
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3. Power BI

Learn:

- data import
- relationships
- visuals

- slicers
- DAX basics
- dashboards

Goal:

- Build 2 dashboards

Best resource:

- Power BI Full Course by Alex The Analyst
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PHASE 2 (Day 31–60)

Become Interview Level

1. Python for Analytics

Only learn what analysts use.

Topics:

- pandas
- numpy
- matplotlib
- data cleaning
- CSV/Excel handling

Ignore advanced DSA.

Python Resource

- [Kaggle Python Course](#)
- [Kaggle Pandas Course](#)

2. Build Projects (VERY IMPORTANT)

Most freshers fail here.

You need:

3 strong projects

Best Project Types

Project 1 — Sales Dashboard

Use:

- SQL
- Excel/Power BI

Questions:

- top products
 - monthly sales
 - regional performance
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Project 2 — Customer Analytics

Analyze:

- retention
 - repeat customers
 - revenue
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Project 3 — End-to-End SQL + Python

Use:

- CSV dataset
 - clean with pandas
 - analyze with SQL
 - visualize with Power BI
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Where to get datasets

- [Kaggle Datasets](#)
 - [Data.gov.in](#)
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PHASE 3 (Day 61–90)

Interview + Job Preparation

1. Resume

Your resume should contain:

- SQL
- Power BI
- Excel
- Python
- projects
- metrics/results

One page only.

2. LinkedIn

Most freshers ignore this.

Do:

- optimize headline
 - upload projects
 - post dashboards
 - connect with recruiters
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3. Mock Interviews

Practice:

- explaining projects
 - SQL logic
 - business questions
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MOST ASKED SQL INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

You MUST master these patterns:

Joins

- customers without orders
- products never sold
- total sales per customer

Aggregations

- top-selling products
- monthly revenue
- averages

Window Functions

- rank products
- top N per category
- running totals

Subqueries

- above-average sales
 - second-highest value
 - inactive users
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BUSINESS QUESTIONS ASKED IN INTERVIEWS

These are VERY common now.

Examples:

“Sales dropped this month. How would you analyze it?”

Expected thinking:

- region-wise
 - product-wise
 - customer-wise
 - seasonality
 - marketing changes
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“How would you identify valuable customers?”

Expected:

- repeat purchases
 - high revenue
 - frequency
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“What KPIs would you track?”

Examples:

- revenue
 - retention
 - conversion
 - average order value
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HOW TO STAND OUT FROM OTHER FRESHERS

Most freshers:

- memorize syntax
- have copied projects
- cannot explain business insights

You should do THIS:

1. Build REAL Projects

Not tutorial copy-paste.

Even simple but genuine projects are powerful.

2. Explain Insights

Not:

“I used SQL.”

Instead:

“I identified that the Electronics category generated 45% revenue.”

That sounds professional.

3. Create Portfolio

Use:

- GitHub
 - LinkedIn
 - Power BI portfolio
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4. Learn Storytelling

Companies LOVE candidates who explain clearly.

5. Practice Speaking

Huge differentiator in India.

Even average technical candidates get selected because their communication is strong.

WHAT LEVEL YOU ACTUALLY NEED

You do NOT need:

- advanced machine learning
- hard coding
- competitive programming

You DO need:

- solid SQL
 - dashboards
 - business understanding
 - communication
 - projects
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DAILY SCHEDULE (REALISTIC)

6–7 hours/day plan

SQL → 2.5 hrs

Power BI → 1.5 hrs

Python → 1 hr

Projects → 1 hr

Interview prep → 30 mins

LinkedIn/Resume → 30 mins

FINAL TARGET BY DAY 90

You should have:

- ✓ 150 SQL questions solved
- ✓ 3 projects
- ✓ 2 dashboards
- ✓ GitHub portfolio
- ✓ LinkedIn optimized
- ✓ Resume ready
- ✓ Mock interview practice
- ✓ Basic Python + Excel
- ✓ Strong joins/subqueries/window functions

IMPORTANT TRUTH ABOUT HIRING

Most companies reject freshers because:

- no projects
- weak SQL
- poor communication
- cannot explain work

Not because they lack advanced knowledge.

You are already developing analytical thinking properly. That matters a lot.

If you continue consistently, you can realistically become employable within this timeline.